

Question:

What are the minimum and maximum possible values of Glasgow Coma Score?

Answer Choices:

- A. Minimum = 3, Maximum = 15
- B. Minimum = 0, Maximum = 13
- C. Minimum = 0, Maximum = 15
- D. Minimum = 3, Maximum = 18

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Finding Reasoning Paths :

1 . Glasgow Coma Scale (GCS) evaluates motor , verbal , and eye-opening responses to assess brain function .

2 . The minimum score corresponds to severe impairment , where a person is un responsive to stimuli and cannot open their eyes .

3 . The maximum score indicates full neurological function , with normal responses in all three categories .

4 . The minimum score cannot be zero because there are non-zero responses (e.g ., opening eyes to pain) .

5 . The maximum score of 15 is the highest possible neurological function score .

Reasoning Process :

1 . **Understanding the Scale** :

- The Glasgow Coma Scale (GCS) assigns scores based on three categories : eye-opening (scores 1 - 4), verbal response (scores 1 - 5), and motor response (scores 1 - 6) .

- Each category contributes to the total score , with the highest possible score being 15 (all three categories scored at their maximum) .

2 . **Minimum Possible Score** :

- The minimum score occurs when a person is completely un responsive . However , at least the eye-opening response must be non-zero to meet the criteria of the GCS . Therefore , the minimum score is 3 , corresponding to :

- Eye-opening to pain (2 points)

- No verbal response (1 point)

- No motor response (1 point)

- Any score below 3 (e.g ., 0) would imply zero response in all categories , which is not possible under the GCS framework .

3 . **Maximum Possible Score** :

- The maximum score occurs when a person has full neurological function in all three categories . This results in the highest possible score of 15 , corresponding to :

- Spontaneous eye-opening (4 points)

- Obedient verbal response (5 points)

- Obeisant motor response (6 points)

4 . **Revisiting the Scale** :

- The GCS is a grading scale , and any score between 3 and 15 reflects varying degrees of brain function . The range from 3 to 15 ensures that the scale is useful for assessing and comparing levels of brain impairment across different patients .

Conclusion :

The minimum possible score on the Glasgow Coma Scale is ** 3 **, and the maximum possible score is ** 15 **. This conclusion aligns with the established range of the scale and ensures the scale is applicable for assessing brain function across a spectrum of impairment .

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<answer>

Minimum = 3 , Maximum = 15

</answer>

3

2

1

0

-1

-2

-3